

Lesson 1: Sounds Around Us

Stage 1 · Lesson 1 · phonemic-awareness

Warm-Up: Listening Game

Adult: Say these directions. Child listens and follows along.

Close your eyes for one minute. What do you hear? Birds?
A car? A clock ticking?

Activity 1: Guess the Sound

Adult makes a sound behind their back (clap, tap pencil, crinkle paper, snap fingers, whistle). Child closes eyes and guesses what made the sound.

Try these sounds: - Clap hands - Tap a pencil on a table - Crinkle a piece of paper - Snap your fingers - Hum a note - Stamp your foot - Ring a bell (if you have one) - Close a book

Activity 2: Loud or Soft?

Adult makes the same sound at different volumes. Child says 'loud' or 'soft.'

Switch roles! Child makes sounds and adult guesses loud or soft.

Activity 3: Sound Walk

Walk around the house together. Stop in each room and listen for 15 seconds. Name every sound you hear. Count them up!

Which room had the most sounds? Which room was the quietest?

Let's Move!

Stand up and be a sound machine! Adult names an animal. Child makes its sound. Switch — child names the animal and adult makes the sound. See who can do 10 animals in a row!

Quick Check

1. What was the loudest sound you heard today?
 2. What was the softest sound?
 3. Close your eyes right now. What do you hear?
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Next lesson: Lesson 2: Voiced and Unvoiced Sounds

Practice at home: Close your eyes before bed tonight.

Name 5 sounds you hear.